



JustFlip!

QUESTION

The capital of France is
[...].

Flip

— PILOT EDITION · SEPTEMBER 2026

UserManual

Anki power, Apple polish — everything JustFlip! can do, and the small print that makes it work.

just-flip.app

Contents

3	Writing great cards	3
3.1	The card editor at a glance	4
3.2	Text that looks right	5
3.3	Fill in the blanks	6
3.4	Big and centred	7
3.5	Maths	8
3.6	Code	9
3.7	Diagrams	10
3.8	Tables	11
3.9	Pictures	11
3.10	Tell the voice what to say	12
3.11	When a card is too long	13
3.12	Cards your memory will keep	13
3.13	Cheat sheet	15

COMING SOON

1 Welcome to JustFlip! **2** Your first review **4** Pictures, sound and occlusion
5 Bringing decks in **6** How scheduling works **7** Learning by ear **8** JustFlip! everywhere
9 Statistics and Ask AI **10** Sync, backups and your data **11** Accessibility and themes

— CHAPTER 3

Writing great cards

A card is a question and an answer. Everything else is optional — and that is where the fun starts. Under the plain text field sits a small, friendly markup language: blanks to fill in, typeset maths, highlighted code, diagrams, tables and words that are read aloud exactly the way you want.

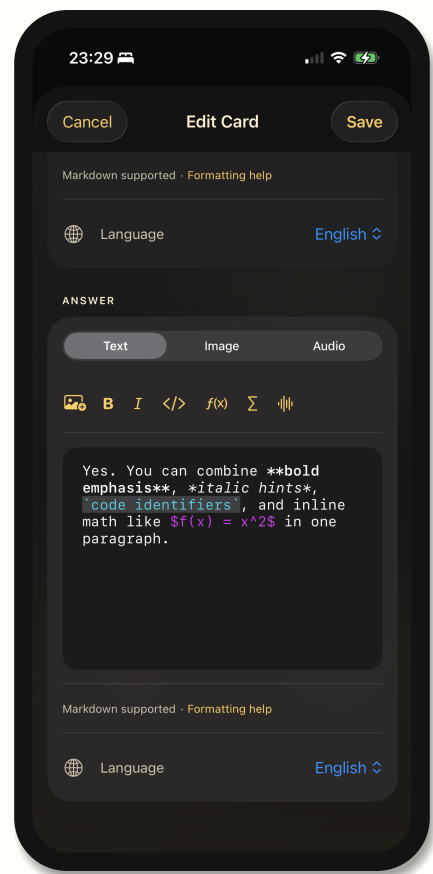
— IN THIS CHAPTER

- Find your way around the card editor
- Style text, add links and fill-in-the-blank cloze cards
- Put maths, code, diagrams and tables on a card
- Add pictures that look good in light *and* dark mode
- Tell the voice what to say — and learn the four places it listens
- Write cards your memory will actually keep



— 3.1

The card editor at a glance



The card editor. Each side has its own Text, Image and Audio tabs, a formatting toolbar and a Language picker.

Every card has two sides, **Question** and **Answer**, and each side is edited on its own. A side has three tabs:

- **Text** — what you type, with the formatting toolbar above it.
- **Image** — one picture from Photos, the camera or a file.
- **Audio** — a recording or an audio file (.mp3, .m4a, .wav).

Below the text field you will find **Formatting help** — a pocket version of this chapter, always one tap away — and the side’s **Language**.

A side can use any mix of text, picture and sound, but it can’t be empty: both the question and the answer need at least one of them before **Save** lights up.

The toolbar

You never *have* to remember the markup. The toolbar above the text field inserts it for you, wrapped around whatever you have selected. It scrolls sideways; from left to right:

Button	Inserts
Picture	the side’s image, at the cursor
B / I	<i>**bold**/*italic*</i>
</>	<code>`inline code`</code>
f(x) / Σ	<code>\$inline maths\$/a \$\$ maths block</code>
Waveform	<code>[shown]{spoken}</code> — a spoken hint
Cloze	<code>{{c1:...}}</code> — a fill-in-the-blank

Button	Inserts
Link	<code>[label](https://...)</code>
Table	a two-column table
Diagram	a <code>mermaid</code> diagram block
Large text	a <code>::: hero</code> block

Language matters

The **Language** picker tells JustFlip! which voice should read that side aloud, and each side has its own — a Spanish word on the front, its English meaning on the back.

⚠ GOTCHA

No language, no voice

A new card starts with its language set to **None**, and a side with no language is simply *not spoken* — not by the speaker button, not by Speak Cards. If a card stays silent, check its language first.

Tags and flags

Tags are typed into a chip field: press Return, the **+** button or a comma to turn the text into a tag. Paste `verbs`, `irregular`, `A2` and you get three chips at once. Letter case doesn't matter and duplicates are dropped. A colour flag makes a card stand out when you browse a deck.

— 3.2

Text that looks right

Card text is Markdown, simplified for small screens. Here is everything that shapes plain text:

YOU WRITE

```
Mitochondria are the powerhouse
of the cell. The function is
`atp_synthase()`.
```



ON THE CARD

ANSWER

Mitochondria are the
powerhouse of the *cell*. The
function is `atp_synthase()`.

↺ Flip

— **bold** and *italic* — emphasis.

- ``code`` — a monospaced snippet.
- `\*` — a backslash shows the next character literally, so `\*not italic\*` keeps its stars.
- A **blank line** starts a new paragraph; a single line break is kept as it is.

GOOD TO KNOW

What is deliberately missing

Cards are small, so a few Markdown habits don't apply. A line starting with `#` is shown as plain text — the hash marks are dropped, there are no headings on a card. List markers such as `-` or `1.` appear exactly as you typed them, which is usually what you want anyway.

Links

`[the guide](https://example.com)` shows *the guide* as a tappable link. Web (`https://`), e-mail (`mailto:`) and phone (`tel:`) links work; any other kind of link is shown as plain text.

— 3.3

Fill in the blanks

A **cloze** card hides part of a sentence. The question shows a blank; flipping the card reveals the missing words, highlighted. It is the fastest way to turn a paragraph of notes into something you can be tested on.

YOU WRITE

```
The capital of France  
is {{c1::Paris}}.
```



ON THE CARD

QUESTION

The capital of France is [...].

Flip

Add a **hint** after a second pair of colons. The hint appears inside the blank, and it is what the voice says instead of the word “blank”:

YOU WRITE

```
{{c1::Mitochondria::organelle}}  
produce most of the cell's ATP.
```



ON THE CARD

QUESTION

[organelle] produce most of
the cell's ATP.

Flip

When the card is flipped, the whole sentence comes back with the answers marked — **Mitochondria** produce most of the cell's ATP. The Answer side of a cloze card is optional. Anything you write there is shown underneath the revealed sentence as extra notes.

⚠ GOTCHA

All blanks on a card hide together

Number your blanks **c1**, **c2**, **c3**... — but in JustFlip! every blank on one card is hidden and revealed *at the same time*, and the card is reviewed as a single item. Want to be tested on each blank separately? Make one card per blank.

Anki users will know the other behaviour: there, each number becomes its own card. That is exactly what happens when you **import** an Anki cloze note — it is split into one card per number, so nothing you studied in Anki is lost.

A few details that save head-scratching:

- Only well-formed blanks count. `{{c0::x}}`, `{{c1::}}` or `{{not a cloze}}` are shown literally, braces and all.
- Need the braces themselves? Write `\{{c1::...}}`.
- Inside code and maths, `{{c1::...}}` is left alone — it stays literal.

— 3.4

Big and centred

Some cards are a single character: a kana, a kanji, a chemical symbol, a chord name. Put it inside a **hero** block and it fills the card:

YOU WRITE

```
::: hero
あ
:::
```



ON THE CARD

QUESTION

あ

Flip

`::: center` does the same without the size change — the content is simply centred. Open the block with `::: hero` or `::: center` on its own line and close it with `:::`.

💡 TIP

Let size be the emphasis

Keep any notes *outside* the block, so they stay regular text, and skip bold or italic inside a hero block. At that size they only add noise.

— 3.5

Maths

JustFlip! typesets maths with TeX syntax, the notation used by mathematicians everywhere. Wrap a formula in single dollars to keep it in the line, or put it between **\$\$** lines to give it its own centred row:

YOU WRITE

The derivative:

```
$$
f'(x) = \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(x+h) - f(x)}{h}
$$
```



ON THE CARD

ANSWER

The derivative:

$$f'(x) = \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(x+h) - f(x)}{h}$$

Flip

ANSWER

The instantaneous rate of change, or the slope of the tangent line to a graph.

$$f'(x) = \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(x+h) - f(x)}{h}$$

▶ Play

...

↺ Flip

A maths card in the app. Formulas stay crisp at any size.

Inline maths works the same way: $E = mc^2$ becomes $E = mc^2$ right inside the sentence. How to make a formula *sound* right when it is read aloud comes in [Tell the voice what to say](#).

— 3.6

Code

Fence code with three backticks and name the language after the opening fence. JustFlip! colours keywords, strings, comments, numbers and types:

YOU WRITE

```
```swift
let answer = 6 * 7
// prints 42
print(answer)
```
```



ON THE CARD

ANSWER

```
let answer = 6 * 7
// prints 42
print(answer)
```

↻ Flip

Recognised language names: Swift, Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, Java, Kotlin, C, C++, C#, Objective-C, Go, Rust, Ruby, PHP, SQL, Bash, Smalltalk/Pharo, JSON and YAML. An unknown or missing name still gives you a clean monospaced block — just without colours. Text inside a code block is shown exactly as written; no markup is applied there.

— 3.7

Diagrams

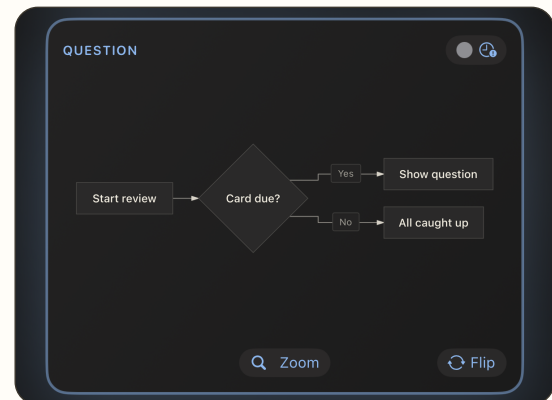
A code block named `mermaid` isn't shown as code at all — JustFlip! draws it. Flowcharts, sequence, state, class and entity-relationship diagrams are all supported.

YOU WRITE

```
```mermaid
graph TD
 A[Start review] --> B{Card due?}
 B -->|Yes| C[Show question]
 B -->|No| D[All caught up]
```
```



ON THE CARD



💡 TIP

Card-sized diagrams

Aim for about eight boxes with short labels. Start with `graph TD` (top-down); JustFlip! may turn a flowchart on its side when that fits the card better. For the details, the **Zoom** button opens the diagram full screen.

— 3.8

Tables

Small comparisons read best as a table. Leave a blank line above it; the first row is the header and is shown in bold:

YOU WRITE

```
Tense	Form
Present	I go
Past	I went
Perfect	I have gone
```



ON THE CARD

ANSWER

| Tense | Form |
|---------|-------------|
| Present | I go |
| Past | I went |
| Perfect | I have gone |

Flip

Cells accept the same formatting as the rest of the card — bold, code, maths. To show a `|` inside a cell, write `\|`.

⚠ GOTCHA

Two columns, five rows

A card table holds at most **2 columns and 5 rows**, header included. Anything beyond that is left out and marked with an ellipsis. Alignment colons such as `|:---|---:|` are accepted, but columns are always left-aligned. A bigger table is usually a sign that the card wants to be several cards.

— 3.9

Pictures

Each side of a card holds **one picture**. Add it on the Image tab, or with the picture button in the text toolbar, which also inserts a marker into the text:

Which bird is this?

![attachment:0]

The marker, `![attachment:0]`, decides *where* the picture sits among the text. A marker with no picture behind it simply shows nothing.

The picture has a **description** field, too. VoiceOver reads it to people who can't see the image, so it is

worth a few words.

⚠ GOTCHA

Transparent pictures vanish in dark mode

A card draws your picture exactly as it is, with no background behind it. Black lines on a transparent background look perfect on a light card and disappear completely on a dark one. Give diagrams, notation and line art a solid white background before you add them.

Use photos and bitmaps (PNG, JPEG). SVG files aren't supported. Keep files reasonably small, too: JustFlip! warns you about anything over 10 MB, because big files slow down iCloud sync on all your devices.

— 3.10

Tell the voice what to say

JustFlip! can read any card aloud, with the voice for that side's language. Usually it gets things right. When it doesn't — an acronym, a symbol, a formula — you can give it a **spoken hint**: curly braces right after something tell the voice to say *this* instead.

YOU WRITE

Enable [iOS]{eye oh ess}
background refresh.



ON THE CARD

QUESTION

Enable iOS background refresh.

↺ Flip

🔊 The voice says: “Enable eye oh ess background refresh.”

The card still shows iOS; the voice says “eye oh ess”. The same rule works in exactly four places:

| Where | You write |
|--|------------------------------|
| Any text, in brackets | [C# minor]{C sharp minor} |
| Inline maths | c^2 {c squared} |
| A maths block — after the closing $\$$ | $\$V$ equals S p v |
| A picture | ![attachment:0]{a red apple} |

Without a hint, text is read normally, maths is read out from its source, and pictures are silent.

⚠ GOTCHA**Braces after anything else are shown**

A hint only works in those four places. After bold, italic or bare text, the braces are shown on the card:

- `*F# major*{F sharp major}` → the card shows *F# major*{F sharp major}
- `*[F# major]{F sharp major}*` → the card shows *F# major* and the voice says “F sharp major”

When in doubt, use brackets. Put any styling *outside* them.

💡 TIP**Hints for what the voice gets wrong**

Hints are for musical sharps and flats, formulas, abbreviations and romanised syllables — things text-to-speech stumbles over. There is no need to repeat what is already written. And for better voices overall, download an Enhanced or Premium voice in the system settings, under **Accessibility › Read & Speak › Voices**, then pick it in JustFlip! under **Settings › Speech › Voices**.

— 3.11

When a card is too long

JustFlip! first tries to fit everything on the card. If the text doesn't fit, it shrinks slightly, down to 80 % of the normal size. If it still doesn't fit, the bottom fades out and a ●●● button appears — tap it to read the full content.

That is a safety net, not a writing style. A card you can't read at a glance is usually two or three cards pretending to be one.

— 3.12

Cards your memory will keep

Formatting makes a card pleasant. These habits make it *work*:

1. **One fact per card.** “What are the three branches of government?” is one card that fails half the time. Three cards, one per branch, each succeed on their own.
2. **Ask precisely.** A question that could have two right answers will teach you neither. Add context — or a cloze hint — until only one answer fits.
3. **Use your own words.** Rephrasing something is the first repetition, and it is free.
4. **Add a picture or a sound** whenever the thing is visual or audible: a bird, a chord, a pronunciation.
5. **Keep question texts unique within a deck.**

 GOTCHA**Two cards, one question**

When you import a deck file (Chapter 5), a card whose question text matches a card already in that deck *updates* that card instead of adding a new one. That makes re-importing a deck safe. But it also means two cards with the very same question text — “Name this note.”, say — become one card. Put a shared prompt in the deck name instead, or leave the question text empty on picture-only cards.

— 3.13

Cheat sheet

| You write | You get |
|---|--|
| <code>**bold** · *italic*</code> | bold · <i>italic</i> |
| <code>`code`</code> | monospaced snippet |
| <code>*</code> | a literal <code>*</code> |
| <code>[label](https://...)</code> | a link (<code>https</code> , <code>mailto</code> , <code>tel</code>) |
| <code>{{c1::answer}}</code> | a blank, revealed on the flip |
| <code>{{c1::answer::hint}}</code> | a blank that shows a hint |
| <code>::: hero ... :::</code> | very large, centred content |
| <code>::: center ... :::</code> | centred content |
| <code>\$x^2\$</code> | inline maths |
| <code>\$\$... \$\$</code> | a centred maths block |
| <code>```swift ... ```</code> | highlighted code |
| <code>```mermaid ... ```</code> | a diagram |
| <code> A B + --- --- </code> | a table, max 2 × 5 |
| <code>![attachment:0]</code> | the side's picture, here |
| <code>[shown]{spoken}</code> | say something else aloud |
| <code>\$x^2\${x squared}</code> | a spoken formula |
| <code>![attachment:0]{a red apple}</code> | a spoken picture |



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